

Rosalind Zimmerling

Character Dossier

Competitive about everything *archivist of the harbor town of Saltmarsh*

Overview

Rosalind Zimmerling is a archivist living in the harbor town of Saltmarsh. Rosalind is 34 years old, originally from the Weeping Shoals, and is known around the Old Quay as competitive about everything. In conversation Rosalind compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Background

Rosalind arrived in the harbor town of Saltmarsh 24 years ago after leaving the Weeping Shoals under circumstances Rosalind describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Harbormasters' Guild; the second was the one that stuck. Today Rosalind works as a archivist near Gull Street market and is paid, when paid at all, in silver marks.

Rosalind learned the trade from Katarina Achterberg, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Rosalind's life is with Nkechi Vasquez-Moor, over a matter neither will explain. The person Rosalind trusts most is Leocadia Hartwell.

Current goal: to prove the old tunnels are real. Greatest fear: crowds that go quiet all at once.

Personality and speech

Temperament: competitive about everything.

Speech pattern: Rosalind compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Tells: when lying, Rosalind mentions Turnip the mouse for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Rosalind Zimmerling
<i>Role</i>	archivist
<i>Home</i>	the harbor town of Saltmarsh
<i>Hometown</i>	the Weeping Shoals
<i>Age</i>	34
<i>Favourite dish</i>	the tavern's peach hand pies
<i>Pet</i>	Turnip, a mouse
<i>Lucky number</i>	868

<i>Workshop password</i>	zephyr-fable
<i>Mentor</i>	Katarina Achterberg
<i>Rival</i>	Nkechi Vasquez-Moor
<i>Closest friend</i>	Leocadia Hartwell

Secret

Rosalind once forged a letter of passage for a stranger who turned out to be a wanted person, and still keeps the copy.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Rosalind: I am the archivist. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Rosalind: The tavern's peach hand pies. Do not tell Nkechi I said so.

Visitor: Is Turnip yours?

Rosalind: Turnip belongs to nobody. Turnip tolerates me. Lucky number is 868, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 13

Rosalind spent the day counting stock at the Old Quay: 74 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Rosalind has a suspect and is probably right. At the Old Quay, Rosalind taught a newcomer how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Rosalind won 46 silver marks on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on supper. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Rosalind and a neighbour outside the Old Quay; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 2, summer of year 13

Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Rosalind has a suspect and is probably right. Rosalind repaired the bolt of linen at the Old Quay for Cassius, who paid in 42 silver marks and a long story about the quarantine. Rumours about the harvest count reached the Old Quay. Rosalind pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 3, summer of year 13

Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Rosalind has a suspect and is probably right. A stranger asked Rosalind for the password to the workshop. Rosalind laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Harbormasters' Guild sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Rosalind read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 4, spring of year 13

Rosalind repaired the pair of spectacles at the Old Quay for Leocadia, who paid in 55 silver marks and a long story about the singing at the docks. The weather turned. Rosalind moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil. At the Old Quay, Rosalind taught a newcomer how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Rosalind closed early, walked to the drydocks, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Rosalind and a neighbour outside the Old Quay; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 5, summer of year 14

Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Rosalind has a suspect and is probably right. The weather turned. Rosalind moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the Brine and Bell tavern. Rosalind pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rosalind closed early, walked to the drydocks, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 6, summer of year 14

Rosalind closed early, walked to the drydocks, and watched the lights come on. Rosalind was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the Brine and Bell tavern to the drydocks without opening it, and mostly

succeeded. Magnus came by asking about the missing shipment. Rosalind said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 7, autumn of year 14

Rosalind was hired to carry a cracked compass from the Brine and Bell tavern to the drydocks without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Kenji came by asking about who really won the regatta. Rosalind said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Rosalind moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta.

Entry 8, summer of year 14

Rosalind spent the day counting stock at the Old Quay: 70 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Rosalind and a neighbour outside the Old Quay; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the Old Quay, Rosalind taught a newcomer how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Rosalind moved the pair of spectacles indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment.

Entry 9, autumn of year 15

Rumours about the new curfew reached the Old Quay. Rosalind pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Rosalind moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the rumour of a second well. Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Rosalind has a suspect and is probably right. Rosalind closed early, walked to Gull Street market, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 10, autumn of year 15

the Harbormasters' Guild sent a notice about the quarantine. Rosalind read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the Old Quay, Rosalind taught a newcomer how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. Rosalind found a sextant half-buried near the Old Quay and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rowan came by asking about the old tunnels. Rosalind said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Rosalind for the password to the workshop. Rosalind laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 11, summer of year 15

Rumours about the quarantine reached the Old Quay. Rosalind pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rosalind closed early, walked to the Tidewatch lighthouse, and watched the lights come on. At the Old Quay, Rosalind taught a newcomer how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Old Quay. Rosalind pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rosalind closed early, walked to the Tidewatch lighthouse, and watched the lights come on.